

First Week Home Checklist

For: Cat — Day-by-day settle-in tasks so the first week feels calm instead of chaotic.

Pet's name: _____

Date home: _____

BEFORE THEY ARRIVE

- ☐ Set up one quiet base room with litter box, food, water, and a hiding spot
- ☐ Keep the litter box far from food and water
- ☐ Buy a few days of their current food to avoid a sudden switch
- ☐ Add a scratching post near their base room

DAY 1

- ☐ Bring them straight to the base room and let them explore in their own time
- ☐ Skip forcing interaction — sit nearby and let them approach
- ☐ Keep other pets separated behind a closed door for now

DAYS 2–3

- ☐ Start a steady feeding schedule
- ☐ Watch litter box use for signs of stress or discomfort
- ☐ Offer a few toy options to see what sparks interest

DAYS 4–7

- ☐ Begin short supervised access to one more room
- ☐ Start slow scent-swapping if introducing another household pet
- ☐ Book their first vet visit if it isn't already scheduled